CareerNest SEO Audit & Backlink Plan

Site: https://careernest.taqnik.in/ | Audited 13 Oct 2026 (IST) | Method: curl + Python crawler (32 URLs incl. all 20 in sitemap.xml), and web research for backlink sources.

1. Summary

The technical base is good: HTTPS with HSTS on Vercel, Brotli compression, fast server responses (12–126 ms TTFB+download from the test box), pages of 10–89 KB, viewport and `lang="en"` on every page, OG and Twitter cards on all public pages, JSON-LD on every public page (WebSite, Organization, FAQPage, HowTo, SoftwareApplication, BreadcrumbList, BlogPosting), a solid robots.txt with a Sitemap line, noindex on login/signup/dashboard/preview, and a working 404. The main problems are **canonical/URL mismatches** and **client-rendered parameter pages that all look the same to crawlers**.

2. Top 5 issues (priority order)

1. **Canonicals and sitemap point to redirecting URLs.** All `*.html` URLs return **308 → extensionless** (e.g. `/pricing.html` → `/pricing`). Every canonical tag and every sitemap `<loc>` still uses the `.html` version, so Google gets mixed signals (canonical → redirect). **Fix:** use the final URLs everywhere (canonical, sitemap, internal links), or turn off Vercel `cleanUrls`.
2. **Blog posts are duplicates in raw HTML.** `blog-post.html?slug=best-resume-power-verbs` and `?slug=cover-letter-secrets-2025` serve the *same* title, description, H1 ("How to Beat ATS…2025") and a canonical pointing to `?slug=how-to-beat-ats-in-2025`. The content is swapped in by JS, so Google will probably fold them into one page. **Fix:** pre-render each post as a static URL (`/blog/best-resume-power-verbs`) with its own meta and a self-canonical. (The blog content being placeholder is fine for now. The template problem matters more.)
3. **Resume-example pages have the same problem.** The 6 `resume-example.html?role=…` URLs in the sitemap all share the title "Resume Example & Guide (ATS-Friendly)", the same description and H1, about 94 words each, and a canonical → `?role=software-engineer`. These could be your best long-tail pages ("data analyst resume example India"), but right now 5 of 6 can't be indexed. **Fix:** make them static per-role pages with unique copy (500+ words), and add a role-specific title and H1.
4. **Thin pages and missing H2s.** `resume-examples.html` (89 words, 0 H2), `cover-letter-generator.html` (165 words), `salary-benchmark.html` (222), `templates.html` (0 H2). Add explanatory content, FAQs and internal links.
5. **Metadata details, plus a broken social link.** 7 titles are over 60 characters (home, form-index, pricing, cover-letter, templates, resume-examples), so they'll be cut off in results. The home H1 ends with a stray " ." The footer/schema links to `https://twitter.com/careernest_ai`, which **returns 404**. Create that handle or remove the link (also check `sameAs` in the Organization schema). `/index.html` duplicates `/` (it's canonicalised correctly, but link to `/` internally).

Other findings

- No `<img>` tags on any page, so image alt text isn't an issue, but there's also no image-search footprint. One OG image (`/og-preview.png`, returns 200) is shared by all pages. Per-page OG images would get more clicks on social shares.

- `http://` to `https://` redirect: **couldn't verify** from the test box (port 80 timed out). Please check it in a browser. HSTS (max-age 2 years) is set.
- `www.careernest.taqnik.in` doesn't resolve. That's fine, but don't use it anywhere.
- `cache-control: max-age=0, must-revalidate` on HTML is fine (Vercel edge cache HIT).
- The robots.txt rules for AI crawlers (GPTBot etc.) are deliberate and well done.
- The year "2025" in blog titles looks dated in Oct 2026. Update it or remove years.
- Core Web Vitals weren't measured (no browser lab run). Run PageSpeed Insights and connect Google Search Console and Bing Webmaster Tools, then submit the sitemap.

3. Backlink strategy (new Indian career platform)

Note: the site sits on a subdomain of taqnik.in. Links to careernest.taqnik.in build that subdomain. If you plan to move to your own domain, do it **before** heavy link building.

Tier A: quick wins (low effort, done in a day or two)

#	Opportunity	URL	Notes
1	Google Search Console + Bing Webmaster	https://search.google.com/search-console	Not backlinks, but required first
2	TechProductIndia (Indian-made products, free listing)	https://techproductindia.com/	Verified: free, permanent SEO-indexed page
3	App Advisor – Launch AI tool (free)	https://appadvisor.in/launch-your-ai-tool	Verified: free, reviewed in 2 working days
4	Koncept AI directory	https://konceptai.in/directory/submit	Verified: free only if you show their badge (or ₹399)
5	Product Hunt launch	https://www.producthunt.com/	Plan the launch day. Good for referrals plus a profile link
6	AI tool directories: There's An AI For That, Futurepedia, Toolify	https://theresanaiforthat.com/ , https://www.futurepedia.io/ , https://www.toolify.ai/	Well-known. Submission terms/prices not verified here
7	Brand profiles: LinkedIn Company Page, Crunchbase, X, Instagram, YouTube, GitHub	https://www.crunchbase.com/	Profile links; also add them to schema `sameAs`
8	Startup India portal profile (if DPIIT-registered), then SuperLaunch	https://www.startupindia.gov.in/ , https://superlaunch.in/submit	SuperLaunch verified: free, needs a DPIIT certificate
9	SaaS review sites: G2, Capterra, SaaSworthy, GoodFirms	https://www.g2.com/ , https://www.saasworthy.com/	Free vendor listings (well-known; not checked one by one)

Tier B: content and PR (medium effort, highest value)

#	Opportunity	URL	Notes
10	Write for Naukri (career guest posts)	https://www.naukri.com/blog/write-for-naukri/	Verified: Google Form or guestpostnaukri@gmail.com. Top authority in Indian careers
11	Jobify India – Write for us	https://jobifyindia.com/write-for-us/	Verified: accepts resume, interview and ATS/HR-tech topics
12	TBD Jobs – Write for us	https://www.tbdjobs.in/writeforus	Verified: 800–1,500 words, info@tbdjobs.in
13	Alliance International – Write for us	https://www.allianceinternational.co.in/write-for-us/	Verified: 900+ words, resume/career topics

#	Opportunity	URL	Notes
14	HireBH – Write for us	https://hirebh.com/write-for-us/	Verified: 1,900–2,500 words, pitch first
15	Journalist-request platforms: Featured.com (runs HARO), Qwoted, Source of Sources, MentionMatch (ex-Help a B2B Writer)	https://featured.com/ , https://www.qwoted.com/ , https://www.sourceofsources.com/ , https://helpab2bwriter.com/	Verified via 2026 reviews: free tiers exist. Pitch as a careers/ATS/hiring expert
16	Indian startup media: YourStory, Inc42, Entrackr (founder story or data story)	https://yourstory.com/ , https://inc42.com/	Pitch a data angle (see linkable assets)
17	#JournoRequest on X; LinkedIn posts by HR journalists	https://x.com/search?q=%23journorequest	Free, speed matters

Tier C: community (ongoing, mostly nofollow, but brings traffic and brand searches)

- **Quora**: answer "ATS resume", "fresher resume", "interview prep" questions and link to the free ATS checker where it genuinely helps.
- **Reddit**: r/developersIndia, r/Indian_Academia, r/resumes, r/cscareerquestionsIN. Follow each sub's self-promotion rules.
- **LinkedIn** articles and newsletter, **Medium/Hashnode/Dev.to** posts that republish guides with a canonical back to your site.
- **Indie Hackers** and **BetaList** for build-in-public visibility.
- Telegram/WhatsApp placement groups (no SEO value, but they drive usage that later earns links).

Tier D: college and placement-cell partnerships (high effort, very high value: .ac.in/.edu.in links)

- Offer T&P / placement cells a **free "CareerNest for Campus" ATS check + resume workshop**. Ask for a link on their placement resources page.
- Find targets with these Google searches: `site:ac.in "training and placement" resources`, `site:edu.in "placement cell" "resume"`, `site:ac.in "career resources" links`.
- Pitch student clubs (E-cells, coding clubs), NSS/alumni pages, and college fest sponsorship pages (small sponsorships often include a website link).
- Get onto **resource pages**: `"resume" "useful links" site:ac.in`, `intitle:"career resources" India`.

Tier E: local and other

- Google Business Profile (if you have an office address), Justdial, Sulekha, IndiaMART. Keep the NAP (name, address, phone) consistent.
- Unlinked brand mentions: set up a Google Alert for "CareerNest" and ask the sites that mention you to add a link.
- Broken-link building: find dead "resume builder" links on career resource pages and suggest your matching tool.

4. Linkable asset ideas

1. **India Fresher Salary Report 2026** (by role/city, built from salary-benchmark data plus public sources). Good for journalists and colleges.
2. **ATS Resume Study**: "We analysed N anonymised resumes. X% fail ATS parsing because of tables or columns." Original data that gets PR links.
3. **Free embeddable ATS score widget / "Resume checked by CareerNest" badge** for college sites.
4. **Campus placement calendar / company-wise interview question bank** (TCS NQT, Infosys, Wipro, Accenture), refreshed every season.
5. **Role-wise career roadmaps** (static, shareable pages and infographics) for Indian tech and non-tech roles.
6. **Free downloadable ATS resume templates (DOCX/Google Docs)** with their own landing pages.
7. **Glossary**: ATS, CTC vs in-hand, notice period, bond terms (people link to definitions).
8. **CTC to in-hand salary calculator (India new tax regime)**. A tool people will link to.

5. 30-day action plan

Week 1: fix the canonical/sitemap URLs, pre-render blog and resume-example pages, fix the Twitter link, set up GSC/Bing. Week 2: Tier A listings plus Product Hunt prep. Week 3: 3 guest-post pitches (Naukri, Jobify, TBD Jobs) and sign-ups on journalist-request platforms. Week 4: emails to 20 placement cells, and publish linkable asset #1 or #8.

"Verified" = page fetched or confirmed through web search on 13 Oct 2026. Other platforms are well known but their terms weren't checked. Confirm them before submitting.